



4.01 Ascending & Descending Trucks

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in ascending and descending trucks and while working at an elevated work area.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by the Silverpoint employees.

3. Hazard Identification

- Physical Stress.
- Personal Injury.
- Slips, Trips and Falls.
- Equipment Damage
- Low Visibility on The Ground

4. EHS Requirements

- FR coveralls.
- Steel Toed Boots with Good Grips.
- Safety Glasses.
- Rubber Gloves.
- Hard Hat.
- Hearing Protection.
- 3 Points of Contact.
- Clean off Snow, Ice and Mud from Steps.
- Do not Jump or Drop Down out of Truck.

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List



Silverpoint THA 4.01

6. Procedure

Please be aware that many injuries occur while climbing in and out of the trucks as this is a frequent task and extra attention should be paid while performing this task. When entering and exiting the truck or elevated work area, you should be using the Three Points of contact system. This means *THREE* of your *FOUR* limbs are in contact with the truck at all times. (E.g., two hands and one foot, or one hand and two feet). Wear proper footwear and always exit and enter facing the cab of truck or elevated work area.

6.1. Ascending

When ascending the truck or elevated work area, please ensure the following :

- 6.1.1. Steps of the truck are clean and free of debris. If steps are clogged, remove any build-up before proceeding.
- 6.1.2. Check to ensure handles are clean and secure.
- 6.1.3. Check boots to ensure they are free of build-up of snow, ice, or mud.
- 6.1.4. Grab handles firmly before stepping onto the first step. Use 3 point climbing technique.
- 6.1.5. Take your time. Do not attempt to skip any steps and keep a firm hold onto the handrails until safely in the truck or safely on the elevated work area.
- 6.1.6. Take your time to climb into the truck or elevated work area safely and move in a controlled manner.

6.2. Descending

When descending the truck or elevated work area, please make sure of the following :

- 6.2.1. Do not attempt to get out of the truck or elevated work area face first as this is an awkward action that increases the risk of injury.
- 6.2.2. Firmly grab hold of the handrail and steering wheel or door handle.
- 6.2.3. Test step to ensure that they are not slippery and provide adequate traction.
- 6.2.4. Take time to climb out of the truck or elevated work area in a safe and controlled manner.
- 6.2.5. At no time should you ever jump off any of the steps.**
- 6.2.6. Always check the ground for unevenness and hazards.
- 6.2.7. Do not use exhaust system grab handle to swing around on and "drop" yourself to the ground or next step.

- 6.3. Points to remember when working above ground level - Always use three points of contact when you are entering or exiting an elevated work area. Most injuries are caused by slips, trips, and falls. Look for hazards before you start the job and remember that new hazards can present themselves while a job is in progress. Take your time; many incidents are caused by rushing. Take a good look at the way you do things, there may be a safer and more efficient way.



- 6.4. On occasion a worker must access a location , area and or place to perform work . It is identified that the work area does not have the most preferred methods of access . These types of situations must be evaluated very carefully . A worker must assess their own physical capability and the area platform or other that needs to be accessed . A rule of thumb is "If you have to jump in any way or form do not attempt access ", you need to determine and implement an alternate method i.e.: steps , ladder , hoist , man lift etc . What -ever method is chosen the worker must implement three points of contact .

NOTE : You may need to go inside the flock tank to perform your task . Access in or out of the tank must be performed with caution . Perform a hazard assessment prior to entry , determine your access point . Use three points of contact always facing the tanks walls .

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do , call your Supervisor